

SDG Goal 12

Responsible consumption and production

SDG Target 12.4

By 2020, achieve the environmentally sound management of chemicals and all wastes throughout their life cycle, in accordance with agreed international frameworks, and significantly reduce their release to air, water and soil in order to minimize their adverse impacts on human health and the environment

SDG Indicator 12.4.1

Number of parties to international multilateral environmental agreements on hazardous waste, and other chemicals that meet their commitments and obligations in transmitting information as required, by each relevant agreement

Time series

(1) Basel Convention

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: May 4, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/12-4-1>
- Definition: The time series shows Germany's compliance with its obligations under the Basel Convention.
- Disaggregation: type of obligation

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2024
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-12-04-01.pdf>
- The time series is compliant with the UN metadata.

3. Data description

- The aim of the 'Basel Convention on the Control of Transboundary Movements of Hazardous Wastes and Their Disposal' is to minimize the transboundary movement of hazardous wastes (special waste), to ensure their environmentally sound disposal as close as possible to the place of generation, and to reduce the overall volume of special waste produced. To achieve these objectives, the transboundary movement of special waste is monitored in particular, thereby helping to prevent illegal shipments.

Germany has been a party to the Basel Convention since 1994.

4. Access to data source

- Legal basis:
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/ALL/?uri=celex%3A32006R1013>
- National contact point:
<http://www.basel.int/Countries/CountryContacts/tabid/1342/Default.aspx>
- National reports:
<http://www.basel.int/Countries/NationalReporting/NationalReports/BC2019Reports/tabid/8645/Default.aspx>

5. Metadata on source data

- General information on the Basel Convention:
<https://www.basel.int/>

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: Not available.
- Frequency:
 - o Contracting Party: Annual
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: Annual
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Every 5 years
 - 1. Reporting cycle 2017: data for the years 2010 to 2014
 - 2. Reporting cycle 2020: data for the years 2015 to 2019
 - 3. Reporting cycle 2025: data for the years 2020 to 2024
 - 4. Reporting cycle 2030: data for the years 2025 to 2029

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement:
 - o Contracting Party: yes=1, no=0
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: yes=1, no=0
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Percentage
- Calculation:

$$\text{Compliance with the agreement}_z = \frac{a + \sum_{i=x}^y b}{6 \text{ [points]}} \cdot 100 \text{ [%]}$$

With:

a = Designation of the Focal Point and one or more Competent Authorities (1 point)

b = Submission of the annual national reports during the reporting period (1 point per report)

x, y = Reporting years for the reporting cycle z

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Time series

(2) Montreal Protocol

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: May 4, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/12-4-1>
- Definition: The time series shows Germany's compliance with its obligations under the Montreal Protocol.
- Disaggregation: type of obligation

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2024
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-12-04-01.pdf>
- The time series is compliant with the UN metadata.

3. Data description

- The Montreal Protocol on Substances that Deplete the Ozone Layer, which aims to protect the ozone layer from substances that cause its depletion in the Earth's atmosphere, was adopted in 1987. Under the Protocol, the signatory states have committed to reducing and eventually phasing out emissions of chlorine- and bromine-containing chemicals that destroy stratospheric ozone. They have also agreed to cooperate on research into the mechanisms of ozone depletion.

The Montreal Protocol covers substances such as CFCs, methyl chloroform, methyl bromide and carbon tetrachloride.

Germany has been a party to the Montreal Protocol since 1989.

4. Access to data source

- Legal basis:
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32024R0590>
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?uri=CELEX%3A32024R0573>
- National contact point:
<https://ozone.unep.org/countries/profile/deu>

- Country data:
<https://ozone.unep.org/countries/profile/deu>
- 5. Metadata on source data
 - General information on the Montreal Protocol:
<https://ozone.unep.org/treaties/montreal-protocol>
- 6. Timeliness and frequency
 - Timeliness: Not available.
 - Frequency:
 - o Contracting Party: Annual
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: Annual
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Every 5 years
 - 1. Reporting cycle 2017: data for the years 2010 to 2014
 - 2. Reporting cycle 2020: data for the years 2015 to 2019
 - 3. Reporting cycle 2025: data for the years 2020 to 2024
 - 4. Reporting cycle 2030: data for the years 2025 to 2029
- 7. Calculation method
 - Unit of measurement: Percentage
 - o Contracting Party: yes=1, no=0
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: yes=1, no=0
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Percentage
 - Calculation:

$$\text{Compliance with the agreement}_z = \frac{a + \sum_{i=x}^y b}{80 \text{ [points]}} \cdot 100 \text{ [%]}$$

With:

a = Submission of information on Licensing systems under (Article 4B of) the Montreal Protocol (5 points)

b = Compliance with annual reporting requirements for production and consumption of controlled substances under Article 7 of the Montreal Protocol (15 points per report)

x, y = Reporting years for the reporting cycle z

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Time series

(3) Rotterdam Convention

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: May 4, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/12-4-1>
- Definition: The time series shows Germany's compliance with its obligations under the Rotterdam Convention.
- Disaggregation: type of obligation

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2024
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-12-04-01.pdf>
- The time series is compliant with the UN metadata.

3. Data description

- Plant protection products, pesticides and industrial chemicals can pose a risk to public health and the natural environment, particularly in developing countries, if they are not used properly. Against this background, the voluntary 'PIC procedure' was introduced in the 1980s to facilitate the exchange of information on the risks and hazards of certain hazardous chemicals and selected hazardous plant protection products and pesticides. PIC ('Prior Informed Consent') means consent following prior notification. The procedure stipulates that exporters of certain hazardous chemicals must obtain the consent of the importing country before an import can take place.

In 1988, the PIC procedure was given legal form through the signing of the Rotterdam Convention. The Convention stipulates that importing countries must be provided with the necessary information on chemicals on the PIC list in order to assess potential risks. A country may refuse to import a PIC chemical if the safe handling of the substance cannot be guaranteed in that country. Further provisions of the Convention, such as labelling requirements for the exporter, contribute to the safe use of the chemicals, provided that the import has been approved.

Germany has been a party to the Rotterdam Convention since 2004.

4. Access to data source

- Legal basis:
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?qid=1616424284711&uri=CELEX%3A32012R0649>
- National contact point:
<https://www.pic.int/Countries/CountryContacts/tabid/3282/language/en-US/Default.aspx>
- Import Responses
<https://www.pic.int/Procedures/ImportResponses/Database/tabid/1370/language/en-US/Default.aspx>

5. Metadata on source data

- General information on the Rotterdam Convention:
<https://www.pic.int/>

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: Not available.
- Frequency:
 - o Contracting Party: Annual
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: Annual
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Every 5 years
 - 1. Reporting cycle 2017: data for the years 2010 to 2014
 - 2. Reporting cycle 2020: data for the years 2015 to 2019
 - 3. Reporting cycle 2025: data for the years 2020 to 2024
 - 4. Reporting cycle 2030: data for the years 2025 to 2029

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement:
 - o Contracting Party: yes=1, no=0
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: yes=1, no=0
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Percentage
- Calculation:

$$\text{Compliance with the agreement}_z = \frac{a + \sum_{i=x}^y b}{2 \text{ [points]}} \cdot 100 \text{ [%]}$$

With:

a = Designation of the Designated National Authority(ies) and Official contact point (1 point)

b = Submission of the import responses during the reporting period (0.2 point per import response)

x, y = Reporting years for the reporting cycle z

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Time series

(4) Stockholm Convention

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: May 4, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/12-4-1>
- Definition: The time series shows Germany's compliance with its obligations under the Stockholm Convention.
- Disaggregation: type of obligation

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2024
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-12-04-01.pdf>
- The time series is compliant with the UN metadata.

3. Data description

- The aim of the 2001 Stockholm Convention (POPs Convention) is to protect human health and the environment from persistent organic pollutants (POPs). Many of these POPs are plant protection products, although they have long been banned in Germany. These substances, which are difficult to break down, are now being detected worldwide, often far from their places of manufacture or use. They accumulate in the fatty tissue of living organisms and can have harmful effects on humans and animals.

As part of the implementation of the Stockholm Convention, governments are taking measures to reduce or ban the release of POPs into the environment. Furthermore, the aim is to prevent the manufacture and use of new substances with POP properties. The import and export of POPs is restricted to specific cases, such as import or export for safe and environmentally sound disposal. Import and export may only take place in compliance with international rules, standards and guidelines.

Germany has been a party to the Stockholm Convention since 2004.

4. Access to data source

- Legal basis:
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?qid=1616424312742&uri=CELEX%3A32019R1021>
- National contact point:
<https://chm.pops.int/Countries/ContactPoints/tabid/304/Default.aspx>
- National reports:
<https://chm.pops.int/Countries/Reporting/NationalReports/tabid/3668/Default.aspx>

5. Metadata on source data

- General information on the Stockholm Convention:
<https://www.pops.int/>

6. Timeliness and frequency

- Timeliness: Not available.
- Frequency:
 - o Contracting Party: Annual
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: Annual
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Every 5 years
 - 1. Reporting cycle 2017: data for the years 2010 to 2014
 - 2. Reporting cycle 2020: data for the years 2015 to 2019
 - 3. Reporting cycle 2025: data for the years 2020 to 2024
 - 4. Reporting cycle 2030: data for the years 2025 to 2029

7. Calculation method

- Unit of measurement: Percentage
 - o Contracting Party: yes=1, no=0
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: yes=1, no=0
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Percentage
- Calculation:

$$\text{Compliance with the agreement}_z = \frac{a + b + \sum_{i=x}^y c}{7 \text{ [points]}} \cdot 100 \text{ [%]}$$

With:

a = Designation of the Stockholm Convention official contact point and national focal point (1 point)

b = Submission of the national implementation plan (1 point)

c = Submission of the revised national implementation plan(s) addressing the amendments adopted by the Conference of the Parties within the reporting period (1 point per revised and updated plan)

x, y = Reporting years for the reporting cycle z

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Time series

(5) Minamata Convention

1. General information on the time series

- Date of national metadata: May 4, 2026
- National data: <https://sdg-indicators.de/12-4-1>
- Definition: The time series shows Germany's compliance with its obligations under the Minamata Convention.
- Disaggregation: type of obligation

2. Comparability with the UN metadata

- Date of UN metadata: July 2024
- UN metadata: <https://unstats.un.org/sdgs/metadata/files/Metadata-12-04-01.pdf>
- The time series is compliant with the UN metadata.

3. Data description

- The Minamata Convention (on Mercury), adopted in 2013, is the most recent multilateral agreement on chemicals. Its aim is to curb mercury emissions worldwide. It thus serves to protect human health and the environment both in areas where mercury emissions are generated directly and in regions to which they are transported.

Future parties to the Convention must ensure that the use of mercury in industrial production is significantly reduced. From 2020, it will be prohibited to manufacture or sell mercury-containing products such as certain light bulbs or thermometers, as well as pesticides and biocides. Furthermore, mercury waste may only be stored and disposed of under strict conditions.

Germany has been a party to the Minamata Convention since 2017.

4. Access to data source

- Legal basis:
<https://eur-lex.europa.eu/legal-content/EN/TXT/?qid=1616424340862&uri=CELEX%3A32017R0852>

- National contact point:
<https://minamataconvention.org/en/parties/focal-points>
 - National reports:
<https://minamataconvention.org/en/parties/reporting/2019>
<https://minamataconvention.org/en/parties/reporting/first-full-national-reports>
<https://minamataconvention.org/en/parties/reporting/second-short-national-reports>
<https://minamataconvention.org/en/national-reporting-pursuant-article-21>
5. Metadata on source data
- General information on the Minamata Convention:
<https://minamataconvention.org/en>
6. Timeliness and frequency
- Timeliness: Not available.
 - Frequency:
 - o Contracting Party: Annual
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: Annual
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Every 5 years
 - 1. Reporting cycle 2017: data for the years 2010 to 2014
 - 2. Reporting cycle 2020: data for the years 2015 to 2019
 - 3. Reporting cycle 2025: data for the years 2020 to 2024
 - 4. Reporting cycle 2030: data for the years 2025 to 2029
7. Calculation method
- Unit of measurement:
 - o Contracting Party: yes=1, no=0
 - o Fulfilment of reporting obligation: yes=1, no=0
 - o Compliance with the agreement: Percentage
 - Calculation:

$$\text{Compliance with the agreement}_z = \frac{a + \sum_{i=x}^y b}{80 \text{ [points]}} \cdot 100 \text{ [%]}$$

With:

a = Designation of a national focal point (Article 17) (5 points)

b = Submission of national report (Article 21) (15 points)

x, y = Reporting years for the reporting cycle z